## 4.12 Valvular Heart Disease and Valve Replacement*

| Assessment | Nursing Diagnosis | Plan / Expected Outcome | Nursing Interventions | Evaluation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Subjective**<br>• "I get breathless on exertion."<br>**Objective**<br>• Murmur<br>• Reduced exercise tolerance<br>• Crackles | **ACTUAL**<br>Impaired gas exchange related to pulmonary congestion from valvular dysfunction as evidenced by dyspnea and crackles. | • After valve surgery, breathing is easier and hemodynamics are stable. | • Follow vital signs, $SpO_2$, ECG and urine output.<br>• Watch for signs of heart failure.<br>• Give medicines as prescribed. | • Goal reached when hemodynamics are stable. |
| **Subjective**<br>• "How long will I take warfarin?"<br>**Objective**<br>• Mechanical valve<br>• Warfarin recently started | **ACTUAL**<br>Inadequate health knowledge related to lifelong anticoagulation as evidenced by questioning. | • Knows his INR target, the dietary points and the signs of bleeding. | • Explain that a mechanical valve means warfarin for life.<br>• Teach why regular INR checks are needed.<br>• Advise a steady intake of green leafy vegetables and a check before any new medicine.<br>• Remind him to tell the dentist before any procedure. | • Met once he explains his anticoagulation. |
| **Subjective**<br>*No specific complaint*<br>**Objective**<br>• Prosthetic valve<br>• Poor oral hygiene | **RISK**<br>Risk for infection as evidenced by risk factors: prosthetic heart valve (endocarditis). | • Understands the need for antibiotic prophylaxis, as advised, and for good oral hygiene. | • Teach daily oral hygiene and regular dental visits.<br>• Advise him to tell the dentist or physician about the valve before procedures.<br>• Ask him to report fever promptly. | • Achieved when he states these precautions. |

* **References for this care plan:** [16], [17], [32], [35]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.